



MANG 6547 BANKING, FINANCE AND RISK DISSERTATION SBS PGT Dissertation Handbook 2024/25

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Dr Mohamed Bakoush, Programme Director – MSc Finance
Email: m.bakoush@soton.ac.uk

Dr Martin Enilov, Programme Director – MSc International Financial Markets
Email: m.p.enilov@soton.ac.uk

Dr Renatas Kizys, Module Leader - MANG6547 Banking, Finance and Risk Dissertation
Email: r.kizys@soton.ac.uk

Dr Gabriele Lepori, Programme Director – MSc Risk and Finance
Email: g.m.lepori@soton.ac.uk

Dr Yun Luo, Programme Director – MSc Shipping Finance
Email: y.luo@soton.ac.uk

Dr Giota Papadimitri, Programme Director – MSc Sustainable Finance
Email: p.papadimitri@soton.ac.uk

Dr Paulo Regis, Programme Director – MSc International Banking and Financial Studies
Email: p.j.regis@soton.ac.uk

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Welcome to the MANG 6547 Banking, Finance and Risk Dissertation!

Welcome to an exciting and important part of your degree: MSc Finance, MSc International Financial Markets, MSc International Banking and Financial Studies, MSc Risk and Finance, MSc Shipping Finance, and MSc Sustainable Finance! This dissertation represents your chance to apply the theoretical knowledge of Banking, Finance and Risk you have gained throughout your programme through a piece of independent study. You will be able to identify your own area of interest to explore in-depth using appropriate research tools. The dissertation will contribute 60 CATS towards the degree (of the 180 CATS needed for the Masters). Please read this handbook carefully and let your supervisor know your questions.

Section 1. How to use this handbook

This handbook has been written to guide you through the key stages of the process of writing your dissertation. It gives you an idea of timings and deadlines so that you can plan your work. Importantly, it includes essential information on how to choose a research topic, how to work with your supervisors, how to structure your dissertation, and guidance on referencing and avoiding plagiarism etc. We encourage you to read the handbook thoughtfully and go back to it as a reference while working on your dissertation. You can get in touch with the module or programme leader if you have any questions regarding this dissertation handbook. We advise you to follow the handbook for your own module/programme for your dissertation and not refer to other programmes' guidance since the requirements and information could be different. Likewise, we encourage you to visit the Blackboard site of MANG 6547 Banking, Finance and Risk. If you are a part-time student, you should check with your supervisor or Programme Leader to plan timescales for your dissertation.

Section 2. Objectives of the dissertation

MANG 6547 Banking, Finance and Risk Dissertation is a core module in six MSc programmes:

MSc Finance

MSc International Banking and Financial Studies

MSc International Financial Markets

MSc Risk and Finance

MSc Shipping Finance

MSc Sustainable Finance

The dissertation is an extended 15,000-word ($\pm 10\%$) assignment based on an independent study of a topic of your choosing. Essentially, the dissertation is a test of your ability to create, *on your own initiative*, a text which demonstrates a Masters-level understanding of a particular issue. You will be assigned a supervisor to advise you on how to approach your work, and it is your responsibility to manage and undertake the necessary work *independently*. Your dissertation should draw on concepts, techniques and frameworks from your previous studies to:

- Identify a suitable topic for study
- Plan and manage an appropriate schedule of work
- Design and undertake an appropriate investigation strategy
- Identify and access useful and suitable sources of information
- Ensure that you have ethics approval and undertake a risk assessment before collecting any data for your research
- Write a well-presented dissertation with a logical structure and suitable formatting.

Section 2.1. Structuring your dissertation

A key feature of any dissertation is the way in which it is structured or organised. Structure is important because it dictates the topics discussed and the order in which they are discussed. A good structure can considerably enhance the finished quality of a dissertation.

Characteristics of a good dissertation structure include:

- Chapters and sections that are ordered in a logical way
- A contents page that clearly differentiates chapter titles and major sub-headings
- Chapter and section headings that are informative, concise and accurate
- Discussion and analysis that develops logically – from general principles or concepts to more specific or detailed analysis and discussion
- Repetition of points is minimal.
- The structure of your dissertation will vary depending on whether it is primarily literature based (e.g. a systematic literature review), empirical research (e.g. a survey of company employees), or action research (e.g. an application of theory or concept in a real-world setting).

***Additional Resources:** An example of the structure and format of a typical dissertation is provided in **Appendix 1**.*

Section 3. How will your dissertation be assessed?

Masters' Dissertations are assessed according to the indicative criteria set out below [weightings are provided in brackets]:

- 1. Introduction, including Aims & Objectives, Research Questions, Contributions to Knowledge [15%]:** Clarity and suitability of the aims & objectives, research questions, significance of the research problem, theoretical focus.
- 2. Literature Review & Hypothesis Development [20%]:** Does it provide evidence of appropriate selection and discussion of relevant literature in Banking, Finance, and Risk? Does it provide evidence of understanding and critical engagement with the discipline? Does the literature add to the understanding of the problem or planned development through effective evaluation and synthesis of a range of literature? Does the literature provide a balanced and unbiased view of any competing theories or views? Does the literature review lead to hypotheses development?

3. **Data [15%]:** Are the sources of data appropriately acknowledged in the dissertation? What is the structure of the dataset (cross-sectional, time-series, or panel)? Are the variables selected adequately explained, justified, appropriate to the aims & objectives, research questions, hypotheses (or problem)? Are the data described with sufficient detail? Are there any limitations envisaged in the data? Are key descriptive statistics summarised and analysed? Are time-series variables visualised via time-series plots (where relevant) and inspected?
4. **Research Methodology [15%]:** Is the research methodology adequately explained, justified, appropriate to the aims & objectives, research questions, hypotheses (or problem), and data? What are the strengths and limitations of the chosen research methodology? What are alternative methodologies?
5. **Analysis of Research Findings [15%]:** Does the analysis/discussion of findings address the aims & objectives, research questions? Do your research findings provide sufficient ground for rejection or non-rejection of financial and/or statistical hypotheses? Are your research findings contextualised within the related literature? Do they provide evidence of understanding of the implications and limitations? Is the discussion of research findings supported with robustness tests? Are there any unexpected findings? Are your research findings visualised in tables and/or diagrams? Are these tables and/or diagrams self-contained?
6. **Conclusion [10%]:** Do the conclusions do more than re-state your research findings? Do they provide implications for financial practice, policy and/or regulation? Do they discuss limitations of your research design (if not discussed in the previous chapters or steps)? Does the concluding chapter identify avenues for future research?
7. **Presentation, Structure & Language [10%]:** Is your dissertation well executed? Is it clearly written? Is it presented using appropriate graphics, tables? Are the external sources of information accurately cited/referenced? Is it well structured, logical and coherent, using appropriate chapter headings?

Section 3.1. Specific marking criteria

Your dissertation will be marked by two examiners, one of whom is *normally* your supervisor. Marking follows the updated [Double-Blind Marking and Moderation Policy](#).

GRADE DESCRIPTOR AND MARKING CRITERIA

Criteria	0 - 24%	25 - 34%	35 - 49%	50 - 59% Pass	60 – 69% Merit	70 - 79% Distinction	80 - 100% Distinction
1. Introduction, including Background, Motivation Aims & Objectives, Research Questions, Contributions to Knowledge [15%] • Background • Motivation • Aims & objectives • Research questions or • Problem definition • Contribution to knowledge	Not stated, confusing, unrelated to title, difficult to understand, inappropriate study	Very limited lacks effective focus and clear rational Too ambitious or too basic	Poorly defined and presented, some confusion in rationale	Clearly stated, some relevance, straightforward	Well stated purpose, appropriate and realistic explanation of the context and/or problem	Very clearly stated, feasible, innovative	Exceptionally well stated, interesting, sophisticated, original, full and convincing justification
2. Literature Review & Hypothesis Development [20%] • Is there evidence of appropriate selection and discussion of relevant literature? • Is there evidence of understanding of, and critical engagement with what has been read? • Does the literature add to the understanding of the research problem/topic through effective evaluation and synthesis of a range of literature? • Does the literature provide provides a balanced and unbiased view of any competing theories or views?	Inadequate and/or irrelevant evidence, virtually no evidence of appropriate selection, no discussion of selection criteria, unsystematic or omitted referencing; no gaps identified; no hypotheses developed	Rudimentary coverage, very limited evidence of understanding, predominantly descriptive writing; disconnect between the selected literature and the hypotheses; irrelevant gaps are identified	Lacks structure with clear gaps, no discussion of selection criteria, unsystematic referencing; limited evidence of understanding and evaluation of the selected literature; limited support provided to the hypotheses; insufficient gaps are identified	A basic coverage of relevant literature; inconsistent referencing; the literature offers some additional understanding of the research problem/topic; the hypotheses are informed by the literature; adequate gaps are identified	Good coverage, awareness of relevant prior research, clear structure, stated selection criteria, consistent referencing, clarity of understanding, the literature, informs and adds to the research problem / topic; reasonable gaps are identified	Comprehensive and inclusive use of highly relevant literature, evidence of critical engagement / writing, good structure, clearly articulated discussion that relates to the topic of research, clear flow of argument leading to the hypotheses; important gaps are identified	Exceptional section that fully demonstrates a discerning, creative and critical engagement the existing literature. Key and latest developments in the literature are discussed. The hypotheses address major gaps in the literature; very important gaps are identified

Criteria	0 - 24%	25 - 34%	35 - 49%	50 - 59% Pass	60 - 69% Merit	70 - 79% Distinction	80 - 100% Distinction
Does the literature review lead to hypotheses development?							
3. Data [15%] - Are the sources of data appropriately acknowledged in the dissertation? - What is the structure of the dataset (cross-sectional, time-series, or panel)? - Are the variables selected adequately explained, justified, appropriate to the aims & objectives, or research questions, hypotheses, or problem? - Are the data described with sufficient detail?	None, totally inappropriate and unrelated	Extremely limited collection of data, poorly identified, insufficiently justified data, limited explanations, limited connection to aims & objectives, or research questions, hypothesis, or problem	Limited collection of data, poorly identified, lack of justification, insufficient or superficial explanations, poorly connected to aims & objectives, or research questions, hypotheses, or problem	Satisfactorily identified, adequately justified, explained; satisfactorily connected to aims & objectives, or research questions, hypotheses, or problem	Good approach to collection, clear validity and reliability, critical analysis using appropriate techniques and appropriate criteria; reasonably connected to aims & objectives, or research questions, hypotheses, or problem	Advanced approaches of collection, clear validity, critical analysis using appropriate techniques and appropriate criteria, fully justified; well connected to aims & objectives, or research questions, hypotheses, or problem	Outstanding analytical techniques and approaches, evidence of creation of new approaches (if appropriate), thorough and rigorous analysis, exceptionally well justified; clearly connected to aims & objectives, or research questions, hypotheses, or problem
4. Methodology [15%] - Is the research methodology adequately explained, justified, appropriate to the aims & objectives, or research questions, hypotheses, problem, and data? - What are the strengths and limitation of the chosen research methodology? - What are alternative methodologies?	No theoretical basis; no discussion or justification of the methodology; highly inappropriate to the aims and objectives, or research questions, hypotheses, or problem; no evidence of critical evaluation	Irrelevant, very limited justification and explanation of the methodology; inappropriate to the aims and objectives, or research questions, hypotheses, or problem; limited evidence of critical evaluation	Insufficient justification and explanation of the methodology. The methodology is weakly connected to the aims & objectives, or research questions, hypotheses, or problem; limited evidence of critical evaluation	Satisfactory justification and explanation of the methodology; reasonably connected to the aims and objectives, or research questions, hypotheses, or problem; some evidence of critical evaluation	Clear and relevant criteria used to identify the methodology; the methodology is supported with evidence, appropriate to the aims & objectives, or research questions, hypotheses, or problem; some awareness of strengths and weaknesses of the approach.	Very clear and relevant criteria used to identify the methodology; persuasive rationale for the selected methodology; addressed the aims & objectives or research questions, hypotheses, or problem; awareness of strengths and weaknesses,	Provides excellent understanding, rigorously argued methodology, strongly supported with evidence; fully addresses the aims & objectives, research questions, hypotheses, or problem; full awareness of strengths and weaknesses,

Criteria	0 - 24%	25 - 34%	35 - 49%	50 - 59% Pass	60 - 69% Merit	70 - 79% Distinction	80 - 100% Distinction
						alternative methodologies	alternative methodologies
5. Analysis of Research Findings [15%] - Does the discussion of findings address the aims & objectives, research questions? - Do your research findings provide sufficient ground for rejection or non-rejection of financial and/or statistical hypotheses? - Are your research findings contextualised within the related literature? - Do they provide evidence of understanding of the meaning and implications of research findings? - Is the discussion of research findings supported with robustness checks/tests? - Are there any unexpected findings? Are your research findings visualised in tables and/or diagrams? - Are these tables and/or diagrams self-contained?	No attempt to relate findings to theory	Findings are not effective, discussion shows no learning from the evidence presented	Discussion shows a very limited awareness of theory and attempt to link this to the findings; insufficient discussion of the meaning and implications of research findings, limited effort to contextualise research findings within the related body of research; no robustness checks	Adequate level of critical analysis of research findings. Adequate discussion of the meaning and implications of the findings; the findings are reasonably connected to the aims & objectives, or research questions, problem or hypotheses; research findings are satisfactorily positioned within the related literature	Some links with aims & objectives, research questions, theories, and hypotheses; discussion supported with appropriate evidence, good critical analysis of the implications of the findings; good visualisation of research findings; research findings are positioned within the related literature; some attention is provided to any unexpected findings	Comprehensive links with aims & objectives, research questions, theories, and hypotheses; complete justification with appropriate evidence, very good critical analysis of the meaning and implications of the findings, and reflection on the strengths and weaknesses of the research or development; research findings are positioned within the related literature; any unexpected findings are discussed	Strong links with aims & objectives, research questions, theories, and hypotheses. Sophisticated and critical discussion of the issues involved, outstanding reflection on the strengths and weaknesses of the research, offers fresh/new insights on the problem or topic; research findings are clearly positioned within the related literature; in-depth discussion is provided about any unexpected findings
6. Conclusion [10%] Do the conclusions do more than re-state your research findings?	Conclusions are not justified by evidence, they do not relate to the topic of the	Conclusions poorly justified by evidence, they have a poor relationship to	Conclusions have limited justification in the evidence, there is limited	Adequate attempt to use evidence to reach appropriate conclusions that relate to the topic	Clear conclusions relating to the topic of the dissertation and justified by the	Clear conclusions with a very good relationship to the topic of the dissertation and	Exceptional conclusions that relate strongly to the topic of the dissertation with

Criteria	0 - 24%	25 - 34%	35 - 49%	50 - 59% Pass	60 - 69% Merit	70 - 79% Distinction	80 - 100% Distinction
- Do they provide implications for financial practice, policy and/or regulation? - Do they discuss limitations of your research design (if not discussed in the previous chapters or steps)? - Does the concluding chapter identify avenues for future research?	dissertation, their development is unclear and incomplete; no implications for practice, policy or regulation; no recommendations/opportunities for further development	the topic of the dissertation, their development is of poor quality; limited implications for practice, policy or regulation; recommendation s/opportunities for further development are not of practical use	relationship to existing theory and the topic of the dissertation; insufficient implications for practice, policy or regulation; very limited recommendations / opportunities for further development	of the dissertation, conclusions may be general and uncritical; satisfactory implications for practice, policy or regulation; adequate recommendations / opportunities for further development	evidence. Reasonably discusses implications for practice, policy or regulation. Identifies clear recommendations / opportunities for further development	justified well by the evidence. Research findings are well connected with practice, policy or regulation. Identifies clear and practical recommendations / opportunities for further development	excellent justification in the evidence. Research findings are clearly connected with practice, policy or regulation. Conclusions add new insight to the topic of the dissertation and identify clear and practical recommendations / opportunities for further development
7. Presentation, Structure & Language [10%] - Is it written in good English? - Is it presented using appropriate graphics, illustrations and accurate referencing? - Is it well structured, logical and coherent, using appropriate chapter headings?	Mostly inarticulate and incomprehensible, very hard to understand and follow, confused and unstructured	Poor presentation, many spelling and grammatical errors, difficult to understand, inappropriately structured	Basic layout, inconsistent flow of argument, a few spelling and grammatical errors, poor citation and reference list, poor structure, confused.	Adequate use of graphics and charts, good command of spelling and grammar, some typos, some omissions or inconsistencies in the reference list, most sections have a logical flow and structure	Clear and effective use of graphics and charts, no spelling or grammatical errors, appropriate and consistent referencing, logical, clear and coherent structure	Very good logical flow and cohesion, Discerning use of graphics, charts and tables, no spelling or grammatical errors, appropriate and consistent referencing, well developed and appropriate structure	Outstanding logical flow, excellent use of language, appealing and effective use of graphics, charts and tables, appropriate and consistent referencing, very skilfully developed structure, outstanding logical flow, most effective use of conventions appropriate for purpose

Section 4. Choosing a topic

Choosing a suitable brief for your research topic and then deciding on a more specific title for your dissertation can be a bit daunting, especially if you have not written a dissertation before. In general, more successful dissertations are those that attempt an in-depth study of a focused topic, rather than attempt a wide-ranging study, which can lack depth.

Your dissertation topic should be based on a particular organisational context or related to a generic banking, finance, and risk issue. Your project should be clearly relevant to some aspect of your studies and overall degree programme. It might also be relevant to your career plans, which can help to enhance your employability. In addition, we strongly advise to choose topic that really appeals to you; otherwise, you might lose your motivation as you progress with your dissertation!

You may find the following tips helpful when choosing your research topic:

- Identify which broad topics you are interested in, then think about more specific questions within that topic
- Think about particular modules which you found enjoyable
- Think about topics that relate to your strengths
- Think about topics that relate to your career plans
- Read review articles or quality news sources in the broad topic area that you want to study to find out what has already been researched and if there are any unknowns that might make good topics. The section of future research from your reviewed articles might provide some ideas
- Read the section of future research from your reviewed articles that might provide some ideas
- Think about access to potential sources of data.

Although the content, structure and format can vary significantly across dissertations, in Banking, Finance and Risk, postgraduate research typically aims to test theories and/or hypotheses using quantitative research methods and statistical data. Of course, we do not discourage research based on primary data and/or

qualitative research methods. However, given a relatively short time window available for your research, it would be more efficient to use econometric/statistical models and software packages taught as part of your degree programme (or in your prior studies). Ultimately, advice needs to be sought from your supervisor as to the type of research and data collection methods that can be used to address the aims & objectives, and research questions in your dissertation.

You should consider a number of factors when deciding on your topic:

- Is the topic **original**, or has it already been researched previously by somebody else?
- Is the topic **relevant** to your field of study?
- Does the topic have **value** to organisations, industries, investors, policymakers, regulators, society, or other researchers in your field?
- Is the topic **achievable** with the time and resources you have available? For instance, if you are collecting company data, is it realistic and have you spoken to your supervisor about this in the early stage?
- Does the topic require **access** to data (for example, companies' financial information, financial market data, etc.) and, if so, do you have that access? For instance, if you are using secondary data, it is essential for you to login relevant databases with our university account and double check the data availability to make sure you can work through your topic. Also, it will be helpful if you have an initial plan of data collection and get a clear mind about how long your data collection process would be. Please note we advise you to take advantage of the datasets subscribed by the University of Southampton or Southampton Business School, or use publicly available data, such as <https://uk.finance.yahoo.com/>. We DO NOT recommend buying data.

Section 5. Planning your work

Give yourself as much time as possible to complete your dissertation by starting early. No two dissertations are the same and different projects will progress at different rates. Table 1 below therefore shows **indicative** key stages in a generic dissertation process with **suggested** dates for full-time students. The dates here are for guidance, and you should plan target dates for your dissertation with your

supervisor and agree a meeting schedule – those suggested below may not all be necessary but you must ensure you progress your dissertation in line with the timings. For part-time students, key milestones should be adjusted in discussion with your supervisor. Make an early start with your dissertation and try to keep to the timings below.

Table 1: The Key Stages in a generic dissertation process.

Key Dates	Key Event
Early May	Start thinking of your research topic or problem you would like to solve, a title of your dissertation. Read around your topic in depth and prepare an initial research proposal, look at examples of dissertations available on Blackboard.
Mid-May	Develop your research ideas into a research proposal. Submit your research proposal to your supervisor, ideally before the first supervisory meeting, and request feedback.
First meeting with supervisor: Late May	Feedback/Progress Meeting. Discuss your research topic or problem, a title of your dissertation, and research methods with your supervisor. Briefly discuss with your supervisor the ERGO approval process (see Section 8 for more information).
Second meeting with supervisor Early June	Proposal signed off by supervisor. Discuss plans for data collection. Consider what ethics approval or risk assessment may be needed. Discuss with your supervisor and draft ERGO paperwork
ERGO deadline: Early June	ERGO documentation should be completed and submitted (<i>absolute deadline to be agreed with your supervisor</i>). Risk assessment completed should be completed too, if relevant.
Third meeting with supervisor: Mid-June	Feedback/Progress meeting. Discuss with your supervisor the literature review & hypothesis development, the availability of data, and the suitability of the proposed methodology. Complete your first draft (introduction, and literature review & hypothesis development) before the end of June, submit it to your supervisor and request feedback.
Fourth meeting with supervisor: End June	Feedback/Progress meeting. Feedback is provided and discussed on your first draft (introduction, and literature review & hypothesis development). Your dissertation is revised and updated in line with the feedback received. Further steps are set out.
Fifth meeting with supervisor: Early to Mid-July	Progress meeting. The dissertation draft is extended to incorporate the methodology and data. Further steps are set out. A second draft is completed and submitted.
Sixth meeting with supervisor: End July	Feedback/Progress meeting. Feedback is provided on the second draft and discussed. Your dissertation is revised and updated in line with the feedback received. Further steps are set out. Final checks on your dissertation structure. Supervision ends. You will now progress independently until the submission deadline.
Wednesday 3rd September 2025	Submission deadline for full-time students

Additional Resources: *you can use the template in Appendix 2 to plan a schedule for your dissertation.*

Section 6. Research topic and proposal

After you have chosen your topic, you will be required to produce a short proposal or topic outline for your dissertation. Your dissertation proposal will form the basis of your early discussions with your supervisor, and you will expand this as you read more about your topic and develop your research. The main items to include in your research proposal are:

- A topic and tentative title, its background, and a justification for its choice
- A question for the focus of the study and the main questions to be investigated
- An explanation of how your study relates to, builds on, differs from, or complements previous work in the field (i.e., How do you identify your research gap?)
- A description of how and what data will be collected
- An explanation of how data will be analysed and interpreted and how this will relate back to the initial questions posed
- A preliminary discussion on the practical value of the study (a brief description of the value of your work to the discipline, wider academic community, companies, investors, policymakers, regulators, and/or to the society and the economy), and any problems that may be relevant to its conduct
- A plan outlining your proposed timescale

Please note any delay in the submission of your proposal will delay the progress of your dissertation. If there are personal reasons that prevent your progress, please notify your supervisor and discuss with your personal academic tutor.

Additional Resources: *please see **Appendix 3** for an example research proposal template.*

Section 7. Working with your supervisor

You will be assigned a supervisor by the Head of Department / Programme Leader.

The role of your supervisor is to:

- Advise on the suitability of the title and scope of your dissertation
- Advise on an appropriate dissertation structure
- Advise on the suitability of the data and methodology
- Advise on your ethics and ERGO application
- Advise you on your work timetable
- Provide formative feedback on your proposal and two drafts of your dissertation (once only and providing these are submitted by the dates agreed with your supervisor)

Supervisors will not normally provide specific advice or guidance on sources of information or literature for your particular topic. The time available for supervision is six hours in total. This time includes group and individual meetings, approving your ERGO application, risk review, email correspondence, and reading/ advising on chapters. Please understand that you should not expect your supervisor to be available during non-working hours. Please also don't expect an instant response, or frequent and lengthy guidance.

To get the most from meeting with your supervisor:

- Be proactive about contacting your supervisor for meetings, it is up to you to drive the process.
- Attend all meetings or reschedule them if you are not able to attend.
- Prepare for your meetings by reading your notes from the previous meeting and completing any actions that you have agreed.
- Send your draft in advance if your meeting is going to discuss your writing.
- You may send a list of your concerns or questions to your supervisor before your meeting.
- Use a range of communication methods and make sure you are contactable during the dissertation process (e.g., face-to-face meetings where possible,

email, phone, MS Teams etc.).

Additional Resources: *you are welcome to use the form in **Appendix 4** to record your meetings with your supervisor.*

Section 8. Ethical approval (ERGO) and Risk Assessment

Guidelines for ethical approval are based on the belief that all your work should be conducted within an ethic of respect for persons, respect for knowledge, respect for the quality of project, and respect for justice and within the law.

In any study, participants will have to establish precise ethical principles of procedure taking the specific context into account. The University of Southampton Research Ethics Policy can be found [on the main website](#).

Section 8.1. What is ERGO

The University uses an online system called ERGO (Ethics and Research Governance Online) to ensure that you maintain the highest standard of ethics and risk management for your dissertation. ERGO ensures that you have considered ethics and assessed ethical and reputational risks related to your study. **Please note, you must also carry out a separate risk review and possibly a risk assessment, which will mean that you are then covered by university Insurance.**

You **MUST** use ERGO to complete all of the relevant ethics forms for the type of research you are conducting and submit them online. You **MUST** obtain ERGO approval before collecting any data. Under no circumstances will ERGO approval be granted retrospectively. Remember an ERGO application takes time to process and you won't get an instant response. Applying too late may lead to penalty.

To create your ERGO application, please go to [the ERGO pages](#). For this application, you will need to use your University login and click 'Create a new submission' to do this. Note that you will have an ERGO reference number from the '*Submission Overview*' tab of your application. Please make a note of your ERGO number. You need to insert it in various documents and cite it if you have an enquiry. If you are

doing your survey in non-English environments, you must provide English and non-English versions. It is best to make sure that you label the files correctly so that the reviewer can see you have included English translations.

There are a range of forms under the folder named “Template Documents” in ERGO, which you will need to work through. You are recommended to approach your supervisor at a very early stage to discuss what you need to do, and which of the documents you need to use for your project. Complete the ‘Submission Questionnaire’ first, the system will then indicate which additional forms you will need to complete. Table 2 below indicates which forms are required for different types of dissertation:

Table 2: Information of ERGO Application Forms.

Type of Dissertation	Additional Forms required
Secondary data: no individuals - Analysis of <i>aggregated</i> individual level data (e.g., GDP, labour force participation rates, fertility rates...) - Analysis of data not relating to individuals (e.g., data on firms or businesses; financial data) - Meta-analyses (i.e., an analysis of studies) - Literature reviews or reviews/analyses of reports, policies, documents, meeting minutes, newspaper articles, films - Analysis of <i>published</i> biographies, diaries, letters, interviews	None (just the ERGO Submission Questionnaire) A common mistake of students using firm-level or country-level data is to wrongly answer question F2 of the online questionnaire as YES. If your secondary data is on individuals (e.g., household survey), then you should state YES. If your secondary data is aggregated (e.g., a firm, a bank, a city, ...), your answer to F2 should be NO.
Secondary data: incl. individuals Secondary data sets (interviews or surveys) involving human participants	Also include: Ethics Application for Secondary Data Analysis This includes interviews/surveys other researchers make available for others to use (i.e., secondary data). A household survey is a common example but there are other possible cases.
Social media data	Also include: Ethics Application Form for Social Media Analysis
Interviews and/or focus groups to collect your own primary data	Also include: - Ethics Application Form - Consent Form - Participant Information Sheet for UG and PGT students - Debriefing Form (if deception used) - A list of your questions

	• Gatekeeper letter/email of invitation if researching in an organisation. (Organisational approval must be acquired before the research / recruitment begins)
Questionnaire to collect primary data	Also include: • Ethics Application Form • Combined PIS and Consent Form for Anonymous Online Surveys v1.1 (will be first page of your questionnaire) • Debriefing Form (will be last page of questionnaire, but this is required only if deception used) • Invitation email (that you will send to respondents) • A draft of your questionnaire • Letter/email of invitation if researching in an organisation. (Organisational approval must be acquired before the research / recruitment begins).

Failure to get ERGO approval before collecting or analysing data is a breach of academic integrity. You will not be able to use any data collected before ERGO approval in your final dissertation. You should therefore ensure that the stated dates for conducting research are consistent on all forms that are presented to ERGO. Ensure that you have allowed **sufficient time** to receive ERGO approval. **You should be aware that approval may take up to 3 weeks (usually at least 10 working days).** For example, if you submit your ERGO application on 1st June, you may **not receive approval until 21st June**. You should NOT therefore plan to collect data until at least three weeks after you submit your ERGO forms.

If you are collecting primary data, the date that you enter on your ERGO application as the date you will start to collect your data should be *after* the date you expect to receive ERGO approval.

Once you have completed the Submission Questionnaire and uploaded the necessary forms, click 'Submit'. At this point you will be able to add any additional comments for the reviewers. You should then add a Supervisor to your submission (this will be your dissertation supervisor). Once you have added your supervisor, there are a few more questions to answer, and then you can click "Submit" to submit your application. You will both receive an email confirming your submission to the ethics system. It is good practice to contact your supervisor to let them know that your ERGO application is ready to review.

PLEASE NOTE: If you are requested to revise your ethics application you will need to address all the corrections recommended and consequently should adjust your data collection dates accordingly.

If you are going to try a different way of collecting your data or recruiting participants, you must submit an amendment to your ethics application and wait for it to be approved. **Remember this may take a further three weeks.**

Section 8.2. ERGO Amendments

Given that the ERGO process may take up to 3 weeks, please give yourself enough time for the process to go through and **do not** submit another ERGO application due to anxiety of waiting. This will slow down the process.

There is considerable flexibility in your initial ERGO application. For example, you may change the title of your project after your application has been approved without needing to re-submit your ERGO form.

If you think that you may need to re-apply to ERGO, because of any change to your original application, please **CHECK WITH YOUR SUPERVISOR first.**

You DO NOT need to revise your ERGO application for any of the following:

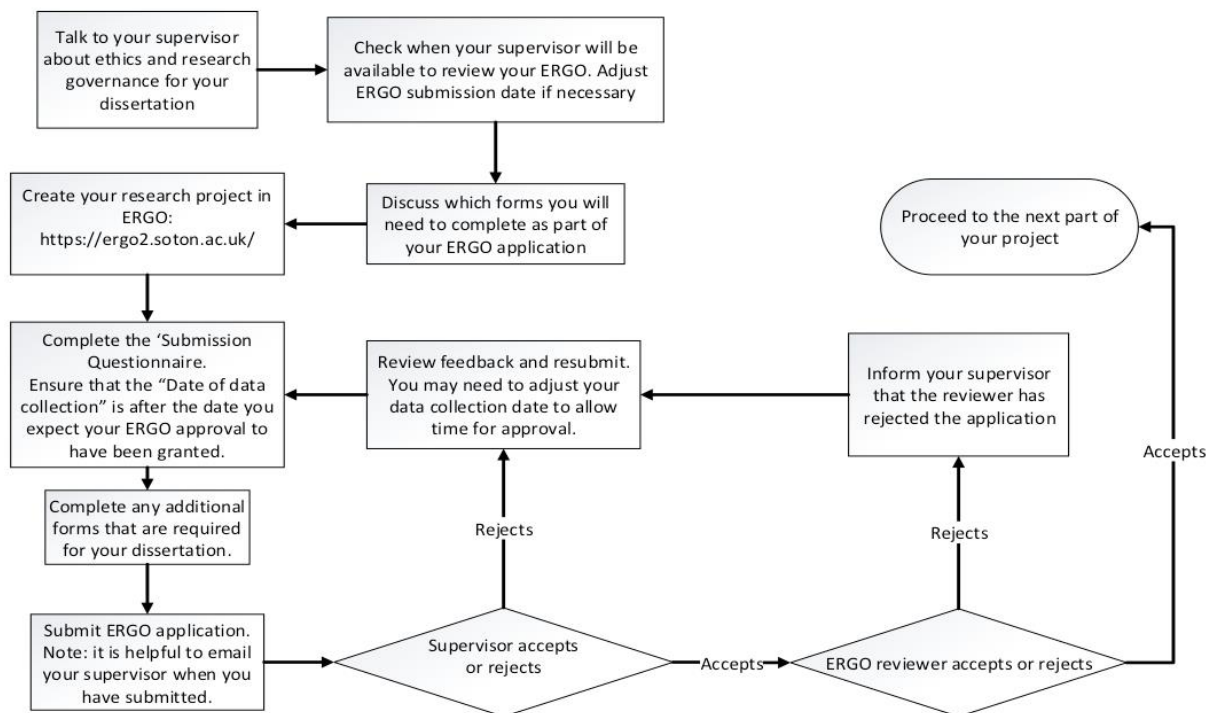
- If you are modifying a questionnaire by adding, deleting or changing some questions
- If you are modifying the number of interviews you intend to complete
- If you are transferring from a secondary financial database to another. For example, it is acceptable to change from CSMAR to Compustat without needing to change your ERGO application
- If you are changing the sample size of secondary data
- If you are changing your method of data analysis. For example, changing from using NVivo to a manual system
- If you decide to omit something for which you already have approval. For example, you may decide that you will not have time to conduct a Focus Group that was part of your initial methods

- If you are modifying your dissertation title.

You DO need to revise your ERGO application for any of the following:

- You are changing your research design. For example, from qualitative to quantitative research
- You are changing your data collection method. For example, from a secondary database to a primary data source; from administering a questionnaire electronically to conducting face-to-face interviews
- If you are adding something to your original design or methods. For example, if you subsequently decide that you want to meet with a Focus Group
- You change the subject or initial direction to a new topic for research.
- If you are going to try a different way of collecting your data or recruiting participants, you must submit an amendment to your ethics application and wait for it to be approved. Remember this may take a further three weeks.

Figure 1. Overview of ERGO Process for Postgraduate Dissertations



Section 8.3. Risk Assessment Guidelines

Supervisors are responsible for ensuring risk reviews are completed for all dissertation research studies. In addition to obtaining ERGO approval you are required to complete a risk review for your planned dissertation research. This must be done BEFORE you begin collecting any data. This is to ensure that you consider fully all the risks to yourself and others for both on-site (e.g., interviews) and off-site research (e.g., surveys), including both domestic and international travel and research conducted outside the university or the UK.

The risk review will help you identify whether you require a full risk assessment. If a risk assessment is needed it will help you to assess the risks and think about how to reduce them. If travel is considered essential to your research, you and your supervisor must request permission from the Dean for international travel and Head of School for UK travel.

Additional Resources:

*all Risk Assessment templates are available at **Appendix 5**.*

Stage One – Prepare for your meeting with your supervisor about the risk review

1. Read through the risk review form.
2. Agree the form with your supervisor and if you need to, complete a full risk assessment.
3. If you don't need a full risk assessment, make sure that both you and your supervisor keep copies of the fully completed risk review.
4. If you do need to complete a risk assessment move on to stage two below.

Stage Two – Risk Assessment (SBS ON- CAMPUS or SBS OFF-SITE)

5. Read through the risk assessment form to familiarise yourself with what information you will need to complete with your supervisor in your risk assessment meeting.
6. Read the basic guidance on how to assess and control risks.
7. Consider what potential hazards there are going to be (meeting students or visitors on campus, travel, working, living in a foreign country etc.), both regarding your health as well as your personal safety.
8. If there is anything you do not understand, or do not know, please speak to your supervisor in your risk assessment meeting.

Stage Three – Risk Matrix

9. This is a general template only, so consider how it could apply to your own research.
10. For each risk you will need to estimate the inherent risk to yourself. You will discuss this with your supervisor.
11. If you know of a risk relevant to your research which is not mentioned on the form, please advise your supervisor.
12. Through discussion with your supervisor, you will consider controls to reduce any risk.
13. The matrix includes suggested controls, but you can add to this if you think of any further action you could take.

Stage Four – Approval Confirmation

14. Make sure the risk assessment is signed by both you and your supervisor.
15. If there are any risks which may pose problems and cannot be mitigated, the risk assessment will need to be considered by the Head of School, and this may require a change of plans.
16. Once completed, ensure that you **keep a copy for yourself and for your next of kin!** It's important to keep all your contact details safe and remind yourself of what control measures you should be undertaking when doing potentially hazardous activities.

Finally, If, during your research, if you feel that a risk has significantly increased, please notify your supervisor as you may need to complete a new risk assessment.

Section 9. Presentation and Formatting

Good presentation is important because it ensures that all your hard work is efficiently and effectively communicated to the reader. It implies neatly set out work; a well-organised, clear, and logical structure; and clear, understandable analysis. It is important to ensure that you:

- Write clear, grammatically correct English without spelling mistakes. Remember the [Study Skills and Language support](#) which is available.
- Make use of chapters, helpful headings, and subheadings to structure your work clearly (see example above). Number your chapters, and number sections within each chapter. Don't forget page numbering throughout.
- Format pages, headings and paragraphs to make the text easy to read.
- Clearly cite ALL sources of information and list FULL details of ALL cited sources in a list of references.
- Logically order material across and within individual chapters.
- Tables and figures are effective ways of presenting data, especially in the results and analysis sections of your dissertation. You should label tables and figures clearly and refer to them consistently in the table of contents and text of your dissertation. Be sure to cite the source of any tables or figures (if you have not developed them yourself). Provide a detailed explanation of a table or a figure in the caption. This will ensure that the table or the figure is self-contained.
- If possible, try not to split tables over two pages. You may need to use a slightly smaller font in tables, or format column headings to read vertically to do this.

Formatting requirements by the Southampton Business School

All dissertations must be in **Times New Roman, Calibri or Arial size 12 font typescript at 1.5 line spacing**. Double spacing may be used at a candidate's discretion for parts involving formulae. The page size should be **A4 (210 x 297 mm), i.e., (21cm x 29.7cm)**. Exemption from the use of this size can only be granted by the School in cases where the subject matter of the project renders the A4 size unsuitable. **Sufficient margins should be made on both edges – the left-hand margin should not be less than 25.4mm or 2.54cm (1”).**

Pages should be numbered consecutively. Tables and diagrams must be numbered serially in typescript.

Word Limit:

The word limit for your dissertation is **15,000 words**. Unless stipulated by the Module Leader, 15,000 ($\pm 10\%$) words is deemed to be acceptable. Any text that exceeds an additional 10% will not attract any marks.

The relevant word count **includes** items such as cover page, executive summary/abstract, title page, table of contents, tables, figures, in-text citations, and section headings, if used. The relevant word count **excludes** your list of references and any appendices at the end of your dissertation submission. Beyond the above points, if you are not sure about whether something is included or not in the relevant word count, please do ask the module leader.

Appendices:

Appendices are not always needed or expected, but they can be a useful way of providing supplementary material which your dissertation draws on, but which is not essential for the reading of the dissertation. It may include background material, supporting evidence or synthetic visuals. Additionally, appendices may contain detailed quantitative, statistical and/or qualitative data, which might be important for further reference but is not directly related to the main thrust of your argument. The attention of the reader should be drawn to the content of the appendices at the relevant parts of the dissertation. Statistical and other analysis of direct relevance to the written text must be included in the main body of the dissertation, possibly as graphs or histograms. Appendices are not a dumping ground for material that you are uncertain how to use and you should be critical about whether the material adds value to your dissertation.

You should always include the word count (from Microsoft Word), at the end of your dissertation, before your list of references.

Section 10. Academic Responsibility and Conduct (ARC)

By now you should be familiar with the requirement for integrity, responsibility and honesty in all the work you do. Given the nature of the dissertation, it is particularly important that you are careful to avoid breaching the ARC [Regulations](#) in your

dissertation. In previous years students have received significantly reduced marks (in some cases zero) as a result of a breach, with consequent significant implications for achieving their qualification overall.

It is your responsibility to ensure that your dissertation meets the University ARC regulations.

Plagiarism (copying parts or all of someone else's work) is obviously wrong, but there are many other ways to breach these [regulations](#). There is substantial guidance available on the [ARC Toolkit](#), on how to avoid these and what the penalties may be.

The following are definitions of the various ways that the ARC regulations can be breached. In extreme cases, these may result in failure of the dissertation module or your overall programme:

- **Plagiarism:** is the use of ideas, intellectual property or work of others without acknowledgement or permission, as appropriate.
- **'Cutting and pasting':** Cutting and pasting of textual material is poor practice and is best avoided altogether, even if you cite material properly and put everything in quotations. The presence of large amounts of cut and pasted material usually demonstrates lack of understanding, lack of originality, rushed work.
- **Cheating/Collusion:** is any action before, during or after an assessment or examination or assessment by which the student seeks to gain unfair advantage or assists another student to do so.
- **Falsification:** is any attempt to present fictitious or distorted data, evidence, references, experimental results or other material and/or knowingly to make use of such material.
- **Breaching ethical standards:** is failing to comply with your ethical obligations when carrying out your Academic Work as set out in the University Ethics Policy and the applicable ethical requirements for your subject area, such as failing to obtain free and informed consent.

- **Misconduct in Research:** includes any of the above examples in relation to research and/or other factors including a failure to comply with regulatory, legal and professional obligations such as a breach of confidentiality, infringement of intellectual property rights, failure to take due care for participants in research or of personal data, and abuse of research subjects or materials (including artefacts).
- **External Authorship/Assistance:** is where somebody else, outside of the university, contributes towards your work. This can be either paid or unpaid. Only submit your own work – presenting others' work as your own is cheating.
- **Proof-reading:** we do not recommend any proof-reader services, or editing or similarity-checking services. Any such service should be used with care and the University offers guidance on [Proofreading](#) within the Toolkit. If your supervisor suggests you need to proof-read your work, it may mean that you should look through your work yourself for errors and do a grammar and spelling check.
- **Mis-use** of Artificial Intelligence tools (see below)

Generative artificial intelligence tools (eg ChatGPT)

Generative artificial intelligence tools, such as the ChatGPT chatbot, are now being used widely, but our [guidance on academic](#) responsibility and conduct stresses that you must produce your own work.

Unless specifically authorised in your assessment guidance, you are not permitted to submit content produced by AI platforms. Presenting such content in any form as your own original work would breach our [academic integrity regulations](#). [Visit the Knowledge Base for general guidance about artificial intelligence tools in relation to academic work](#)

Additional guidance on recycling a research proposal

Recycling (sometimes known as 'self-plagiarism') is an academic offence and is

defined in the University academic regulations as:

“where a piece of work that has already been submitted for assessment, is resubmitted, in whole or in part, for assessment in the same or in a different programme of study without appropriate acknowledgement and/or permission”

If you do use a proposal that was written earlier, it should be reviewed and improved for use as the basis your dissertation. This must be acknowledged in the declaration of authorship (see example title page in the appendices).

If you include material from assessed coursework other than research proposals, (for example essays relating to the subject of your dissertation) then you must acknowledge this as a source in your references. Material that has been previously submitted for assignments (other than research proposals) will not attract marks for your dissertation. It is good academic practice to expand and develop on previous work and acknowledge the original source, even if it is your own work. You can refer to your own work in the **Harvard Referencing style** as follows:

Surname, Initial. (Year of submission) 'Title of essay/assignment', *Module code: Module title, Degree title*, Institution. Unpublished essay/assignment.

For example:

Bloggs, J. (2016) 'Globalisation has increased the complexity of managing people in the 21st century. Briefly summarise why this is and, where possible, illustrate your understanding of this complexity with reference to real world examples.', *MANG6212: Essay Writing Skills, MSc Management*, University of Southampton. Unpublished essay.

Referencing

It is essential that you indicate clearly throughout your dissertation the source of any material you refer to including papers, textbooks, websites, interviews, newspapers, questionnaires, etc. This applies to all text, diagrams, data, tables, and appendices in your dissertation. **You should refer to the latest version of the Business School Harvard Referencing Guide produced by the library.** This is available from [the library website](#).

Section 11. Guidance on submission and extensions

Specific guidance on how to submit your dissertation via e-assignment will be provided in advance of the submission date.

Your dissertation will be marked by two examiners, one of whom is *normally* your supervisor. Marking follows the University of Southampton [Double-Blind Marking and Moderation Policy](#).

Late Submission

Late submissions will be penalised in accordance with the [regulations](#) that apply to your programme.

Extension Requests

There are strict criteria for granting extensions. You will need to fill in a form available on the [Student Hub](#) – full advice on this is given here but you should consult your supervisor and personal academic tutor as advised. Extension requests, along with supporting evidence, should be submitted prior to the submission date. Extensions can only be granted for circumstances beyond your control. If needed, there is further information regarding the [regulations governing extension requests](#) on the main university pages.

Special Considerations

If you believe that illness or other circumstances have adversely affected your academic performance, you must complete a Special Considerations form. All claims must be substantiated by written documentary evidence, for example a medical certificate or GP/consultant letter, self-certification or a statement from your academic tutor. The purpose of asking for supporting documentation is for you to be able to corroborate the facts of your submission. All claims will be reviewed by the Faculty's Special Considerations Board. [More detailed information](#) regarding the regulations including those governing Special Considerations are

available.

The [Special Considerations Form](#) can be found on the [Student Hub](#) and you will find full guidance there, including advice to talk to your supervisor or tutor. The [Quality Handbook](#) contains additional guidance.

Attendance Requirements

Tier 4 Visa holders should be aware that there are strict requirements until their programme end date. You are expected to stay in the UK for the duration of your course and only travel if you have explicit permission from your supervisor. The [student visa pages](#) explain this fully.

Section 12. Additional resources and support links

Section 12.1. Recommended software, where needed

- ☑ For empirical research (with quantitative methods), the University offers several software packages from www.software.soton.ac.uk, such as MATLAB, SAS or STATA. If you work off campus, you need to have installed a VPN.
- ☑ Additionally, if you wish to use STATA for your empirical research, you can use STATA either on a university computer (on campus) or your own computer.
 - First, if you wish to download and install STATA on your own computer, then you first need to install the Southampton Virtual Environment (SVE) via the following URL: <https://sve.soton.ac.uk>. Once you have installed the SVE you should be able to access STATA.
 - Second, you can take advantage of educational discounts on STATA for use on your own computer by clicking on this link [here](#). This requires purchasing your own licence, which is reasonably priced.
 - Third, STATA is available on all common learning space PCs to relevant users on Campus. The shortcuts are in All Programs>Statistics. Or you can download it from the Software Centre.

- ☑ If you are planning to employ qualitative research methods, the University recommends and offers support for various **survey software**. Microsoft forms is recommended for simple surveys – see the [iSolutions page](#) for more details.
- ☑ [Qualtrics](#) is also available for conducting more complex on-line surveys. To register a Southampton Qualtrics account, you must use your University of Southampton email account.
- ☑ **You must have the agreement of your supervisor to use any other platform for survey collection.**

Please note that the Faculty discourages students from surveying University of Southampton staff or/ and students. If you decide to do so, you will need to obtain a permission from the Head of School or the Dean.

Section 12.2. Library support and databases

- ☑ The library offers guidance on [literature sources and library support](#).
- ☑ Guidance on many of the databases available to support your dissertation research is available from [the library site](#)
- ☑ Specific guidance on financial databases is available from [the Financial Laboratory \(Finlab\)](#) and there will be further support offered in the summer.

Additional Resources:

*you can find more Databases information in **Appendix 6**.*

Section 12.3. Study skills and language support

Southampton Business School students can access a wide range of support to help you to develop study skills and improve your academic English as you complete your dissertation. There will be lots of relevant resources on your Blackboard

module for S4B. We would advise against writing in your mother tongue and translating-but you write your work in English.

[LinkedIn Learning](#) is a library of high-quality video tutorials on a wide range of software and business topics. Your university account gives you access to all of it for free.

A series of materials relating to research methods can be found here: <https://generic.wordpress.soton.ac.uk/researchmethods/>

Section 12.4. One-to-one data analysis support sessions

The Education Development Office (EDO) at Southampton Business School will offer a series of tutorial sessions to support PGT students in doing data analysis for their dissertations. Specifically, qualitative/quantitative/financial data analysis and ERGO will be covered in these sessions. Students can book one-to-one sessions to speak to a data tutor, and each session runs for 20 minutes. Students will receive an email when these sessions become available.

Appendices

Appendix 1. Example of a typical Dissertation Structure

PLEASE NOTE: the dissertation structure may vary depending on the type and subject of the research.

The University of Southampton

2024/25

Faculty of Social Sciences

Southampton Business School

MSc Dissertation

(Title of your dissertation)

ERGO number: (your ERGO reference number)

Student number: (your student registration number)

Presented for MSc (your degree programme)

This project is entirely the original work of student registration number (your student number). I declare that this dissertation is my own work, and that where material is obtained from published or unpublished works, this has been fully acknowledged in the references. This may include material of my own work from a research proposal that has been previously submitted for assessment for this programme.

Word Count: xxxxx words

[INCLUDE A PAGE BREAK AFTER EACH SECTION]

Abstract

The abstract is a summary of your dissertation (normally no more than 300 words) that includes: a summary of the situation or problem you have researched; an overview of the methods you have used to investigate it; what you found out and your main conclusions and recommendations.

Acknowledgements

This section is optional and provides an opportunity to thank those who have supported you with your dissertation (for example friends, family, academics, or participants)

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2.1 Subsection.....	6
2.1.1 Subsubsection etc.....	6
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etc...	

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etc...	

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etc.	

Chapter 1: Introduction

1.1 All dissertations should have an effective introduction which may include the following:

- A brief explanation of the nature and significance of the dissertation topic, and the problems or issues implicit in the dissertation title. Some contextual statistics or general evidence/information may be useful here.

- What your interest/motivation for working on this topic is (for example, relevant previous work experience, or personal links with a company or issue).
- The aims & objectives of your dissertation.
- The research questions your dissertation seeks to answer.
- An outline of the approach/methodology you have adopted.
- The contributions to knowledge.
- An overview of the line of argument your dissertation will follow (not simply a list of what each chapter contains).

Chapter 2: Literature Review and Hypothesis Development

2.1 Discusses prior research in order to: identify relevant theories and concepts; describe the extent of current understanding and identify outstanding problems/issues. An effective review will *critically analyse* the literature to support the rationale for your dissertation research by:

- Comparing and contrasting different perspectives in the literature, ensuring that the literature review is balanced and unbiased;
- evaluating the relevance, reliability, and validity of the sources;
- identifying any limitations or biases that may have affected the research;
- identifying connections between the literature and how knowledge of the subject is structured;
- explaining how the literature is relevant to the topic of your dissertation.
- The literature review will help you identify any gaps and will help you derive the hypotheses that you are planning to test.

Chapter 3: Data

3.1 This section builds on the literature review & hypothesis development. In this section, you can:

- Identify and acknowledge the sources of data that you are planning to use in hypothesis testing or problem solving.
- Justify the selected data in the light of the aims & objectives, research questions, hypothesis, or problem.
- Discuss the structure of the dataset (cross-sectional, time-series or panel).

- Discuss why the selected data/variables are appropriate to the aims & objectives, research questions, hypotheses, or problem.
- Describe the data with sufficient detail.
- Discuss any data limitations.
- Summarise and visualise the data in figures and tables, where possible.

Chapter 4: Methodology

4.1 Builds on the literature review and the data to address the aims & objectives, answer the research questions, solve the research problem, or test the hypotheses. In this chapter, it is expected to cover:

- The justification (pros and cons) of the chosen methodology. Why is the chosen methodology preferred over other alternatives?
- Explain how that methodology enables you to address the aims & objectives, answer the research questions, test the hypotheses, or solve the research problem.
- If you are planning to use a regression model, you would need to identify the dependent and explanatory variables and explain how you control for other influences.

Chapter 5: Results and Analysis (sometimes called Findings)

5.1 Present results in as complete, clear and helpful way as possible, analyse results in a useful way, critically comment on the quality of responses and the reliability/limitations of the findings. In quantitative research, it is standard to use tables and figures in this section to communicate your data clearly and concisely. Tables and figures should be numbered and titled. Refer to tables and figures in your text by using the table or figure number. For example (see Table 5.1 or see Figure 5.1 below).

Table 5.1: Example of a table in a dissertation document

Category	Result 1	Result 2
Category 1	Data 1	Data 2
Category 2 etc...	Data 3	Data 4

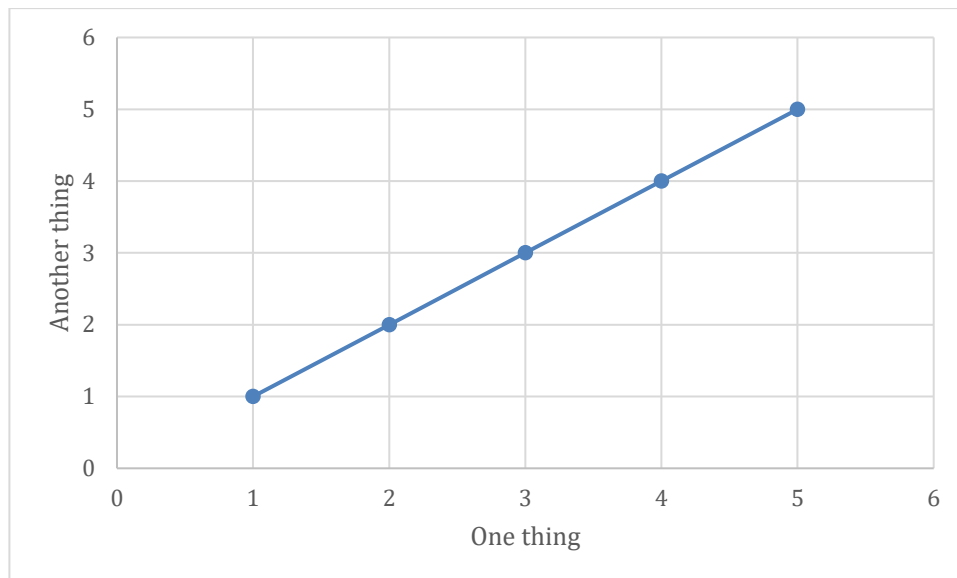


Figure 5.1 Graph showing the relationship between one thing and another thing

In this chapter, you will be expected to deliver:

- An explanation if, and, if so, how analysis/discussion of findings achieves the aims & objectives and answers the research questions.
- A discussion whether findings lead to a rejection / non-rejection of the hypotheses, or if the research problem is solved.
- A discussion how findings can be positioned within the existing literature.
- An explanation of the meaning and implications of results.
- A robustness analysis (i.e., do they receive support from robustness checks?)
- An analysis/discussion of any unexpected results?

Chapter 6: Conclusion

6.1 All dissertations need a conclusion chapter that adds value, rather than merely summarises previous chapters. An effective conclusion should include:

- A summary of key research findings.
- A discussion of potential implications of your research findings for policy, practice, and regulation.
- Limitations of the scope, quality, and validity of the analysis undertaken in the dissertation.
- Recommendations for further research.

References

A single list of **all** sources used in your dissertation using Harvard referencing. You should consult the library webpages for guidance on how to reference with Harvard using the examples in Cite Them Right (available online via the library webpages or in hardcopy). See <http://library.soton.ac.uk/sash/referencing> for more information.

Appendix 1

Label each appendix using roman numerals (e.g. Appendix I, Appendix II, Appendix III etc.) and pages numbered within the appendix (I1, I2, ... II1, II2 etc).

Appendix 2. Dissertation Writing Schedule

Use this schedule template to help you to plan your dissertation writing process.

You may find the following tips helpful:

- It is best to start with the submission date and work backwards.
- Plan to submit your dissertation at least two weeks before the final deadline to give you some protection against delays caused by unexpected problems.
- Include in the schedule any other major commitments you may have during the dissertation-writing period (e.g., examination revision).
- Once you have drafted your schedule, think about when the best times for you would be to meet with your supervisor, agree the dates with your supervisor and insert them into the schedule.

Stage of the dissertation writing process	Number of days/ weeks needed	Start date	End date
<i>STAGE ONE: Reading and research</i>			
a) Seek to identify an original, manageable topic			
b) Reading & research into chosen topic			
<i>STAGE TWO: The detailed plan</i>			
a) Construct a detailed plan of the dissertation			
<i>STAGE THREE: Initial writing</i>			
a) Draft the various sections of the dissertation			
b) Undertake additional research where necessary			
<i>STAGE FOUR: The first draft</i>			
a) Compile and collate sections into first draft of dissertation			
b) Check the flow of the dissertation			
c) Check the length of the dissertation			
d) Undertake any additional editing and research			
<i>STAGE FIVE: Final draft</i>			
a) Check for errors			
b) Prepare for submission			
c) Final proof-read and final editing			
d) Compile reference list			
e) Submit your dissertation			

Appendix 3. Example of a Research Proposal

The University of Southampton Business School

MSc Dissertation – Research Proposal, Ethical Approval and Risk Assessment

This will be the basis for initial discussion as to the ethics and/ or risk approval (ERGO) you need. Please check the 'Proposal/ Topic Submission' folder in the Blackboard Dissertation module for guidance on how to submit for your programme and print out a copy for your first meeting with your supervisor. (Please note: you are not required to do this if you are conducting an industry-sponsored project). Once completed the proposal should be approximately 2-sides of typed A4.

NAME (in full): **Student No.:**

Programme:

Proposed Dissertation Title:

a) Briefly explain your research question(s)

b) Briefly explain your methodology and your reasons for choosing it.

c) Give two key references (research papers or books?), which you have used to inform your choice.

d) According to your research design above, do you need ethical approval for working with human participants (e.g. surveys) or potentially sensitive secondary data (e.g. combining data from multiple sources)? YES/ NO

(NOTE all dissertation research must be entered on the UoS ethics approval system, ERGO)

Supervisor Comments - This section may be used by your supervisor to provide feedback after your first meeting. Please note: some supervisors may provide feedback in other ways.

(To be printed for discussion and signature: one copy may be retained by supervisor)

Student Signature

Supervisor Signature

Print name

Print name

Appendix 4. Supervision Meeting Notes

Use this template for recording your supervision meetings.

Meeting Date:	
General notes:	
Agreed action points:	
Action	Deadline
Supervisor:	Date:
Signed _____	
Student:	Date:
Signed _____	

Appendix 5. Risk Review and Assessment Forms

Business School Risk Review and Assessment Guidelines Version 1.1 Reviewed March 2024

In addition to obtaining ERGO approval, it is essential to complete a risk review for your planned dissertation research. This must be done **BEFORE** you begin collecting any data. This is to ensure that all students fully consider the risks to themselves (and others) for both on-site (interviews) and off-site research, including both domestic and international travel, also research completed outside the university, or outside the UK. For the majority, there is no need for a full risk assessment, but the risk review will help you identify if this is the case. The risk assessment, if needed, will help you to assess risks and think about how to reduce them. Also, if travel or research is considered essential by a student and their supervisor, but is considered unsafe in accordance with University advice (Activity) and/or FCDO advice (International Travel), they must make the case to the Dean, for international travel, or to the Head of School, for University advice.

Stage One – Prepare for your meeting with your supervisor about the risk review

10. Read through the risk review form.
11. Agree the form with your supervisor and if you need to, complete a full risk assessment.
12. If you don't need a full risk assessment, make sure that both you and your supervisor keep copies of the fully completed risk review.
13. If you do need to complete a risk assessment move on to stage two below.

Stage Two – Risk Assessment (SBS ON-SITE or SBS OFF-SITE)

14. Read through the risk assessment form to familiarise yourself with what information you will need to complete with your supervisor in your risk assessment meeting.
15. Read the basic guidance on how to assess and control risks.
16. Consider what potential hazards there are going to be (travel, working, living in a foreign country etc.), both regarding your health as well as your personal safety.
17. If there is anything you do not understand, or do not know, please speak to your supervisor in your risk assessment meeting.
18. If you are planning research outside the UK you will also need to complete the International Travel Form.

Stage Three – Risk matrix

19. This is a general template only, so consider how it could apply to your own research.
20. For each risk you will need to estimate the inherent risk to yourself. You will discuss this with your supervisor.
21. If you know of a risk relevant to your research which is not mentioned on the form, please advise your supervisor.
22. Through discussion with your supervisor, you will consider controls to reduce any risk.
23. The matrix includes suggested controls but you can add to this if you think of any further action you could take.

Stage Four – Approval Confirmation

24. Make sure the risk assessment is signed by both yourself and your supervisor.
25. If there are any risks which may pose particular problems and cannot be mitigated, the risk assessment will need to be considered by the Head of School, and this may require a change of plans.
26. Once completed, ensure that you **Keep a copy for yourself and for your next of kin!** It's important to keep all your contact details safe and remind yourself of what control measures you should be undertaking when doing potentially hazardous activities.

Finally If, during your research, you feel that a risk has significantly increased, please notify your supervisor as you may need to complete a new risk assessment.

University of Southampton Health & Safety – Research Risk Review Form

Version 1.1: Reviewed 12 March 2024

Please tick the box that applies to you - **Undergraduate** ☐ **Postgraduate (Taught)** ☐

Degree programme/Certificate :

Name:	University email address:
Supervisor :	Other researchers /collaborators (if applicable):
Title of Study:	
Expected start date and duration:	
1. Does your research involve collecting your own (primary) data?	
Specifically, do you intend to use: Interviews/ Focus Groups: YES ☐ NO ☐ 2. Questionnaires/Surveys: YES ☐ NO ☐ 3. Physical Observation/ Company Visits: YES ☐ NO ☐	
<i>If you have answered 'NO' to all of the above you do not need to do a full risk assessment.. If you answered 'YES' to any question please answer question 2</i>	
2. You have indicated above that you will collect your own data – how will you collect it?	
Method of data collection (please tick all relevant boxes): a) OFF-SITE research ☐ b) ON-SITE interviews ☐ c) Teams or online: ☐ d) Telephone ☐ e) Email/Web ☐ f) Post ☐ <i>If your answer to a) or b) above is yes, you will need to complete a full risk assessment. If you are collecting data remotely, by phone, online or by post, you are not at any additional risk in comparison to normal university activities. If your planned research requires on-site interviews you need to consider all possible risks. This also applies for travel and off-site visits, when you must also understand if your activities will be covered by University insurance or if you need to have your own cover.</i>	
3. If you are intending to collect data face to face during a visit what travel will this involve?	
Nature of travel (please tick all relevant boxes): a) Day visits within the UK ☐ b) Overnight stays within the UK: ☐ c) Day visits in home country ☐ d) Overnight stays within home country ☐ e) Other ☐ <i>If your planned research requires travel and off-site visits, and in particular overnight stays, you need to consider all possible risks and understand if your activities will be covered by University insurance or if you need to have your own cover. ed.</i>	
Student Signature:	Date
Supervisor Signature:	Date

***Generic Risk Assessment for Southampton Business School Students carrying out ON-SITE research for their dissertations**

NOTE: Students undertaking research for their dissertations may be involved in on-site interviews or gathering data. This risk assessment is intended to ensure students consider and mitigate these risks and the activities connected to it. *It is an essential requirement that a copy of the final version of this risk assessment is kept by the student and by the supervisor*

Before you commit to this form:

1. Read through this generic risk assessment and decide whether all hazards relevant to the proposed research are covered
2. If existing hazards are identified as needing further controls for ANY category, then these must be entered in the further controls column
3. If there is any additional hazard not included in this risk assessment, it must be added in Part C and renamed as a specific risk assessment
4. Once all hazards have been recognised, residual risks must be calculated depending on the individual situation and control measures. Refer to the assessment guidance at the bottom of this document to calculate the risks

Important: An **incident/accident report** must be completed where incidents occur. LINK: [Incident Reporting](#) **Emergencies** – [First Aid](#) – [call 023 8059 3311 from a mobile phone, 3311 from an internal University phone. 999 for an ambulance, fire and or police attendance](#)

Risk Assessment for the Activity of	ON-SITE Research for UG or PGT dissertations
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Note of declaration for this Generic Risk Assessment: After careful consideration of the content of this document and the proposed overall low risk research, the **Student** and **Supervisor** have both confirmed that this is a suitable & sufficient risk assessment. It is mandatory for the **Student** and **Supervisor** to read and understand this generic risk assessment, and for the **Student** to adhere to the controls for all the relevant hazards that will/may apply.

Student Name		Student Signature and date	
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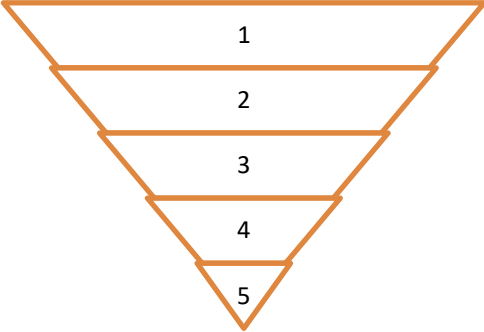
University of Southampton School/Programme/Year	Supervisor		Date
	<i>Name</i>	<i>Signature</i>	<i>Date</i>
If permission for specific activities needed:	Head of School/Dean of Faculty		
	<i>Name</i>	<i>Signature</i>	<i>Date</i>

PART A – Emergency Preparedness										
(1) Risk identification			(2) Risk assessment					(3) Risk management		
Hazard	Potential Consequences	Who might be harmed (Student; those nearby; those in the vicinity; members of the public)	Inherent			Control measures (use the assessment guidance, page 11)	Residual			Further controls (use the assessment guidance, page 11)
			Likelihood	Impact	Score		Likelihood	Impact	Score	
1. Fire, Incident, Accident no available contact information and/or communication	Damage to belongings, Injury, death. University unable to establish student's safety and health	Student, others				Student will: - ensure they are aware of the location of fire exits/routes and assembly points for the University buildings visited and any further instructions provided. - lodge their itinerary and contact details with their academic tutor/supervisor				
2. Loss or theft of passport, driving licence, money, belongings	Stress, inconvenience and financial loss due to loss, theft or fraud	Student				Student is advised: - to keep important documents/items on hand, or secured, if possible - to have back-up arrangements and contact number in case of theft - to have access to emergency numbers to cancel lost or stolen cards and make arrangements to obtain alternative monies				
3. Adverse weather conditions, affecting outdoor activities	Delays, anxiety, Injury	Student, others				Students is advised to: - research possibility of adverse weather conditions prior to activity, keeping updated with news coverage and weather forecasts - ensure they are adequately prepared for extreme weather conditions, either hot, cold, fog, flood, ice, snow etc... - begin activity only if safe to do so				
4. Slips, trips and falls	Injury	Student, those nearby				Student is advised to: - take due care and attention - report incidents, accidents via the University's reporting system (please see link on page 1) - avoid potentially hazardous areas and take care on narrow staircases - avoid using the mobile phone when trying to undertake other activities such as walking				

PART B – Wellbeing										
(1) Risk identification			(2) Risk assessment					(3) Risk management		
Hazard	Potential Consequences	Who might be harmed (user; those nearby; those in the vicinity; members of the public)	Inherent			Control measures (use the assessment guidance, page 11)	Residual			Further controls (use the assessment guidance, page 11)
			Likelihood	Impact	Score		Likelihood	Impact	Score	
1. Threat to personal safety	Injury, stress	Student				Student is advised: - to follow the controls for personal safety on the HSR website - if after dark avoid walking alone if at all possible and avoid less reputable and dark areas - to remember it is often noticeable to others, that you are in an unfamiliar location, so remain vigilant at all times				
2. Threat of illness/disease/virus	Being infected and/or becoming unwell. Spreading to others	Student, those nearby, those in the vicinity, members of the public				Student must: - follow University and government guidelines if there is a virus threat and wear facecoverings and wash hands frequently (if and when directed) - keep updated with UK and other news - ensure vaccinations are up to date where relevant - avoid other people if feeling unwell and seek medical help - obtain adequate supplies of prescribed medication within sufficient time prior to activity				
3. Physical, mental health conditions, underlying phobias, allergies*	Students may not be adequately supported if underlying health conditions are not disclosed Student placed in unsafe situations.	Student				Student will ensure: - engagement with occupational health professional/other support professionals to develop reasonable adjustments - engagement with services such as the Student Hub to access additional support where necessary - Additional time allocated, prior to activity, to prepare plans in relation to accessibility requirements. - Advanced planning and consideration to include food (diabetics) and other necessary adjustments <i>Students are encouraged to disclose personal factors to enabling practioner/academic tutor/supervisor, so that reasonable adjustments can be made</i>				

PART C – Additional Hazards										
(1) Risk identification			(2) Risk assessment				(3) Risk management			
Hazard	Potential Consequences	Who might be harmed (user; those nearby; those in the vicinity; members of the public)	Inherent			Control measures (use the risk hierarchy)	Residual			Further controls (use the risk hierarchy)
			Likelihood	Impact	Score		Likelihood	Impact	Score	
1.										

Assessment Guidance

1.	Eliminate	Remove the hazard wherever possible which negates the need for further controls	If this is not possible then explain why	
2.	Substitute	Replace the hazard with one less hazardous	If not possible then explain why	
3.	Physical controls	Examples: enclosure, fume cupboard, glove box	Likely to still require admin controls as well	
4.	Admin controls	Examples: training, supervision, signage		
5.	Personal protection	Examples: respirators, safety specs, gloves	Last resort as it only protects the individual	

5	5	10	15	20	25
4	4	8	12	16	20
3	3	6	9	12	15
2	2	4	6	8	10
1	1	2	3	4	5
	1	2	3	4	5

LIKELIHOOD

IMPACT

Likelihood	
1	Rare
2	Unlikely
3	Possible
4	Likely
5	Very Likely

Impact		Health & Safety
1	Trivial - insignificant	Very minor injuries e.g. slight bruising.
2	Minor	Injuries or illness e.g. small cut or abrasion which require basic first aid treatment even in self-administered.
3	Moderate	Injuries or illness e.g. strain or sprain requiring first aid or medical support.
4	Major	Injuries or illness e.g. broken bone requiring medical support >24 hours and time off work >4 weeks.
5	Severe - extremely significant	Fatality or multiple serious injuries or illness requiring hospital admission or significant time off work.

Risk process

1. Identify the impact and likelihood using the tables above.
2. Identify the risk rating by multiplying the Impact by the likelihood using the coloured matrix.
3. If the risk is amber or red – identify control measures to reduce the risk to as low as is reasonably practicable.
4. If the residual risk is green, additional controls are not necessary.
5. If the residual risk is amber you can continue but you must identify and implement further controls to reduce the risk as low as reasonably practicable.
6. If the residual risk is red do not continue with the activity until additional controls have been implemented and the risk is reduced.
7. Control measures should follow the risk hierarchy, where appropriate as per the pyramid above.
8. The cost of implementing control measures can be taken into account but should be proportional to the risk i.e. a control to reduce low risk may not need to be carried out if the cost is high but a control to manage high risk means that even at high cost the control would be necessary.

***Generic Risk Assessment for Southampton Business School Students carrying out OFF-SITE research for their dissertations**

NOTE: Students undertaking research for their dissertations may be involved in visiting organisations or companies to carry out interviews or gather data. This risk assessment is intended to ensure students consider and mitigate these risks and any involved in travelling or other activities connected to it.

1. The Supervisor may sign either this unaltered generic document, or one which includes additional low risk hazards in PART G, which are not identified in PARTS A-F. The title above must be changed from *Generic to Specific.
2. Any proposed additional hazards of concern/higher risk should be referred to the Head of School. If approved, then a specific risk assessment must be completed by the Student, independently or together with the Supervisor. This document can be used as a template, but the title above must be changed from *Generic to Specific.

Before you commit to this form:

1. Read through this generic risk assessment and decide whether all hazards relevant to the proposed research are covered
2. If existing hazards are identified as needing further controls for ANY category, then these must be entered in the further controls column
3. If there is any additional hazard not included in this risk assessment, it must be added in Part G
4. Once all hazards have been recognised, residual risks must be calculated depending on the individual situation and control measures. Refer to the assessment guidance at the bottom of this document to calculate the risks

Important:

- It is an essential requirement that a copy of the final version of this risk assessment is kept by the student and by the supervisor
- An **incident/accident report** must still be completed where incidents occur out of the office, but whilst working on University business, whether in the UK or overseas. LINK: [Incident Reporting](#)

Information to assist with determining generic/specific requirements

TRAVEL/ACTIVITIES that may require further/specific assessment due to an increased, may include but are not restricted to:

- Travel Warnings ■ Health Warnings ■ Terrorist Warnings ■ Natural Disasters ■ Political unrest ■ Extreme Weather
- Any other warnings – so please check as requested.
- Personal Physical/Mental Health support/requirements ■ Organisational Risks (ie. Factories/Construction Sites)
- Overseas Research

Risk Assessment for the Activity of	<i>Research for UG or PGT dissertations</i>		
Note of declaration for this Generic Risk Assessment: After careful consideration of the content of this document and the proposed overall low risk research, the Student and Supervisor have both confirmed that this is a suitable & sufficient risk assessment in each of the following categories - PARTS A-G inclusive. It is mandatory for the Student and Supervisor to read and understand this generic risk assessment, and for the Student to adhere to the controls for all the relevant hazards that will/may apply. Note of declaration for a Specific Risk Assessment: After careful consideration of the content of this specific risk assessment and the proposed research, the Student and Supervisor have both confirmed that this is a suitable & sufficient risk assessment in each of the following categories - PARTS A-G inclusive. It is mandatory for the Student and Supervisor to read and understand the specific risk assessment, and for the Student to adhere to the controls for all the relevant hazards that will/may apply.			
Student Name		Student Signature and date	
University of Southampton School/Programme/Year	Supervisor		Date
	<i>Name</i>	<i>Signature</i>	<i>Date</i>
If permission for travel or specific activities needed:	Head of School/Dean of Faculty		
	<i>Name</i>	<i>Signature</i>	<i>Date</i>

NB When filling in this risk assessment there may be sections within PARTS A-F which are not relevant to your research activity. If both you and your supervisor agree, then you may strike through those you have identified as unnecessary, for your individual research. But be aware that any condition/ situation identified as HIGH RISK will require further careful consideration and will need a specific risk assessment.

PART A – Research Location/Area (where visits to organisations/ companies are required)										
(1) Risk identification			(2) Risk assessment					(3) Risk management		
Hazard	Potential Consequences	Who might be harmed (Student; those nearby; those in the vicinity; members of the public)	Inherent			Control measures (use the assessment guidance, page 11)	Residual			Further controls (use the assessment guidance, page 11)
			Likelihood	Impact	Score		Likelihood	Impact	Score	
1. Lack of awareness of area/location of organisation and associated accommodation	Threat to personal safety due to evident lack of confidence in unfamiliar surroundings/ locations	Student				Students should be aware that studying or working offsite is not in itself a dangerous experience but, like every person travelling, you may need to be more aware of your personal safety than when you are at home. While you are offsite: • don’t take any unnecessary risks • seek local advice where necessary, such as local areas to avoid • be alert when travelling alone or at night • consider buildings and persons you are visiting • consider clothing and behaviour, prior to planning research/study trips • be aware of laws, tradition, religious and cultural customs, depending on both your destination and research				
2. Adverse weather conditions	Delays, anxiety, additional costs, Injury	Student				Students is advised to: • research possibility of adverse weather conditions prior to travel, keeping updated with news coverage and weather forecasts, it may include your destination. • ensure they are adequately prepared for extreme weather conditions, either hot, cold, fog, flood, ice, snow etc... • travel to their destination, only if it is safe to do so				
3. Terrorism, natural disasters, hostage/political/religious situations	Injury, imprisonment etc.	Student, those nearby, those in the vicinity, members of the public				Student is advised to: • keep updated with news coverage, it may include your destination/ location • be aware of suspicious behaviour, particularly near public buildings, structures or bridges, also inside buildings at specific entry/exit points, stairwells, hallways or fire escapes • be aware of vehicles parked in suspicious circumstances, possible watching of buildings or structures, also slow moving vehicles, near public buildings, structures or bridges • Know how to react				

PART B – Emergency Preparedness										
(1) Risk identification			(2) Risk assessment				(3) Risk management			
Hazard	Potential Consequences	Who might be harmed (Student; those nearby; those in the vicinity; members of the public)	Inherent			Control measures (use the assessment guidance, page 11)	Residual			Further controls (use the assessment guidance, page 11)
			Likelihood	Impact	Score		Likelihood	Impact	Score	
1. Fire, Incident, Accident at destination with no available contact information and/or communication	Damage to belongings, injury, death. University unable to establish student’s safety and health.	Student, others				Student will: - adhere to health and safety information provided by the designated organisation(s), to include the location of fire exits/routes and assembly points at both the workplace and accommodation visited and any further instructions provided. - lodge their itinerary and contact details with their academic tutor/supervisor				
2. Loss or theft of passport, driving licence, money, belongings	Stress, isolation, inconvenience and financial loss due to loss, theft or fraud	Student				Student is advised: - to keep important documents/items on hand, or secured, if possible - to use secure storage in accommodation, do not leave valuables on display, carry documents, cards or cash discreetly; carry bags across body rather than on shoulder - to have back-up arrangements and contact number in case of theft - to have access to a copy of passport/driving licence, as proof of identity, and an appropriate credit card that can be used to pay for expenses if money is lost or stolen - to have access to emergency numbers to cancel lost or stolen cards and make arrangements to obtain alternative monies				
3. Travelling without insurance details. (For Specific queries contact: insure@soton.ac.uk 023 8059 2417 or 023 8059 4790)	Unable to make contact with the University’s Insurance Office/University’s insurers. Unable to get medical treatment, resulting in the worsening of medical conditions/injuries	Student				Prior to departure, student should: - research whether the trip is covered for the area(s) visited and the activities that are undertaken, (planned and un-planned). - have access to and understand, the cover provided under the University’s travel insurance details throughout the trip. (overnight stays and longer) - have access to and understand the cover provided under the University’s Liability insurance details for single day trips.				

PART C – Travel/Transport required for research										
(1) Risk identification			(2) Risk assessment				(3) Risk management			
Hazard	Potential Consequences	Who might be harmed (user; those nearby; those in the vicinity; members of the public)	Inherent			Control measures (use the assessment guidance, page 11)	Residual			Further controls (use the assessment guidance, page 11)
			Likelihood	Impact	Score		Likelihood	Impact	Score	
1. Travel accident/incident when commuting in own or hired vehicle, bicycle or walking	Accident/Incident, resulting injury to self, loss of property or worse	Student, members of the public				Student will - be aware of and consider weather conditions, laws, rules and road safety, prior to travelling If using own or hired form of transport at any stage: - driving licence must be valid and in date and suitable for the vehicle being used and ensure own cars, scooters or motorbikes are fit for purpose, roadworthy with adequate and valid insurance cover, the same will apply to the hiring of scooters and motorbikes, however this should be avoided if possible. Ensure bicycles are roadworthy - wear protective clothing and equipment including crash helmets and good working lights - visibility to be of utmost importance - must be fully aware of other road users when using a bicycle, and remain vigilant of vehicles and use marked crossings where possible when walking				
2. Travel and commuting using public transport	Accident/Incident, resulting injury to self, loss of property or worse	Student, members of the public				Student is advised to: - be aware that coach and rail stations are often in less reputable areas of cities/towns - plan journey from arrival point using pre-booked coach/taxi or recognised public transport; avoid travelling alone if possible - travel in occupied parts of carriages or buses; arrange to arrive in daylight if possible – if after dark then arrange to be met and avoid walking alone - keep important documents/items hidden and out of sight when travelling - always carry a mobile phone to make calls to friends, family or emergency services if necessary				

PART C – Travel/Transport required for research										
(1) Risk identification			(2) Risk assessment				(3) Risk management			
Hazard	Potential Consequences	Who might be harmed (user; those nearby; those in the vicinity; members of the public)	Inherent			Control measures (use the assessment guidance, page 11)	Residual			Further controls (use the assessment guidance, page 11)
			Likelihood	Impact	Score		Likelihood	Impact	Score	
3. Travelling alone or to unknown areas for research	Getting lost or stuck, working remotely and unable to ask for help	Student				Student is advised to: - plan trips in advance, always travel during the day and check in with the organisation/accommodation when arriving and leaving. - have a contact number at the organisation/accommodation for further assistance - take a physical map and phone for directions - avoid taking lone trips wherever possible - check government and local advice on travel destination				
4. Travelling in own vehicle or organisation’s vehicle for research purposes	Accident/Incident, resulting injury to self, loss of property or worse	Student, fellow travellers, members of the public				Student must: - ensure adequate business use insurance covers the vehicle - let a colleague know the purpose and location of trip, as well as expected arrival and return times - have an organisation contact number in case of emergency				

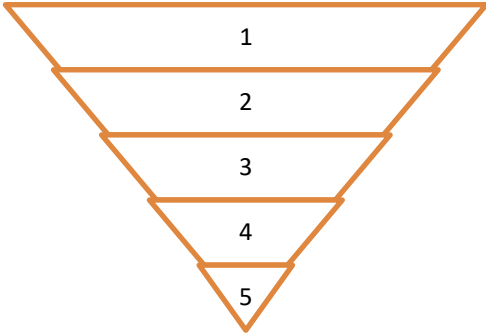
PART D – Accommodation, if required, for visits										
(1) Risk identification			(2) Risk assessment				(3) Risk management			
Hazard	Potential Consequences	Who might be harmed (Student; those nearby; those in the vicinity; members of the public)	Inherent			Control measures (use the assessment guidance, page 11)	Residual			Further controls (use the assessment guidance, page 11)
			Likelihood	Impact	Score		Likelihood	Impact	Score	
1. (see Emergency Preparedness) – PART B 1.										
2. Poor Standard of accommodation (hotel or similar) (e.g. in an unsafe location, a poor state of repair, unsafe in terms of fire risk, poor hygiene and inadequate security.)	Crime, violence, accidents due to the condition of accommodation, serious injury/death due to inadequate fire controls and poor hygiene standards	Student				Student is advised to: - investigate beforehand to ensure only reputable and recommended agencies are approached – preferably recommended by the organisation or University. - get advice about suitability and safety of location and check on accommodation security - Consider distance and route from accommodation to work/study location - any requirements, including mobility impaired accessibility have been considered - personal belongings of high value should be kept in a safe/stored out of sight. NOTE: keep passports, mobile phones, credit/debit cards, wallets secure at all times				
3. Living with new people or back at the family home	Disagreements and arguments. Poor mental health. Loneliness	Student, those nearby				Student is advised to: - see A1 above - keep an active social life and regularly check in with friends and family - access support services available through the University or recognised organisations - use support services such as the University Enabling First Support Service if/when necessary				

PART E – Activity										
(1) Risk identification			(2) Risk assessment				(3) Risk management			
Hazard	Potential Consequences	Who might be harmed (Student; those nearby; those in the vicinity; members of the public)	Inherent			Control measures (use the assessment guidance, page 11)	Residual			Further controls (use the assessment guidance, page 11)
			Likelihood	Impact	Score		Likelihood	Impact	Score	
1. Slips, trips and falls	Injury	Student, those nearby				Student is advised to: - take due care and attention - report incidents, accidents to the organisation being visited, and also via the University’s reporting system (please see link on page 1) - avoid potentially hazardous areas and take care on narrow staircases - avoid using the mobile phone when trying to undertake other activities such as walking				
2. Remote Working	Neck and eye strain. Lack of communication with colleagues and managers	Student				Student must: - take frequent breaks to allow for time to rest and use the correct desk furniture wherever possible - schedule regular meetings with tutors/supervisors to monitor progress, keep communication open and clarify if any help is needed - keep emergency contact details on hand in case of incident or accident				

PART F – Wellbeing										
(1) Risk identification			(2) Risk assessment					(3) Risk management		
Hazard	Potential Consequences	Who might be harmed (user; those nearby; those in the vicinity; members of the public)	Inherent			Control measures (use the assessment guidance, page 11)	Residual			Further controls (use the assessment guidance, page 11)
			Likelihood	Impact	Score		Likelihood	Impact	Score	
1. Threat to personal safety	Injury, stress	Student				Student is advised: - to follow the controls for personal safety in PART A (3) and PART C (3) - if after dark avoid walking alone if at all possible and avoid less reputable and dark areas - to remember it is often noticeable to others, that you are in an unfamiliar location, so remain vigilant at all times				
2. Threat of illness/disease (including COVID)	Being infected and/or becoming unwell. Spreading to others	Student, those nearby, those in the vicinity, members of the public				Student must: - follow University, organisation(s) and government guidelines - wear facecoverings and wash hands frequently - keep updated with UK and other news and ensure professional medical advice is obtained prior to placement when necessary - ensure vaccinations are up to date where relevant - avoid other people if feeling unwell and seek medical help - obtain adequate supplies of prescribed medication within sufficient time prior to travel				
3. Physical, mental health conditions, underlying phobias, allergies*	Students may not be adequately supported if underlying health conditions are not disclosed Student unable to travel or placed in unsafe situations.	Student				Student will ensure: - engagement with occupational health professional/other support professionals to develop reasonable adjustments - engagement with services such as Enabling First Support to access additional support where necessary - Additional time allocated, prior to travel, to prepare plans in relation to accessibility requirements. - Advanced planning and consideration to include transport, accommodation, food (diabetics) and destination(s). <i>Students are encouraged to disclose personal factors to enabling practioner/academic tutor/supervisor, so that reasonable adjustments can be made</i>				

PART G – Additional Hazards										
(1) Risk identification			(2) Risk assessment				(3) Risk management			
Hazard	Potential Consequences	Who might be harmed (user; those nearby; those in the vicinity; members of the public)	Inherent			Control measures (use the risk hierarchy)	Residual			Further controls (use the risk hierarchy)
			Likelihood	Impact	Score		Likelihood	Impact	Score	
1.										

Assessment Guidance

6.	Eliminate	Remove the hazard wherever possible which negates the need for further controls	If this is not possible then explain why	
7.	Substitute	Replace the hazard with one less hazardous	If not possible then explain why	
8.	Physical controls	Examples: enclosure, fume cupboard, glove box	Likely to still require admin controls as well	
9.	Admin controls	Examples: training, supervision, signage		
10.	Personal protection	Examples: respirators, safety specs, gloves	Last resort as it only protects the individual	

5	5	10	15	20	25
4	4	8	12	16	20
3	3	6	9	12	15
2	2	4	6	8	10
1	1	2	3	4	5
	1	2	3	4	5

LIKELIHOOD

IMPACT

Likelihood	
1	Rare
2	Unlikely
3	Possible
4	Likely
5	Very Likely

Impact		Health & Safety
1	Trivial - insignificant	Very minor injuries e.g. slight bruising.
2	Minor	Injuries or illness e.g. small cut or abrasion which require basic first aid treatment even in self-administered.
3	Moderate	Injuries or illness e.g. strain or sprain requiring first aid or medical support.
4	Major	Injuries or illness e.g. broken bone requiring medical support >24 hours and time off work >4 weeks.
5	Severe - extremely significant	Fatality or multiple serious injuries or illness requiring hospital admission or significant time off

Risk process

9. Identify the impact and likelihood using the tables above.
10. Identify the risk rating by multiplying the Impact by the likelihood using the coloured matrix.
11. If the risk is amber or red – identify control measures to reduce the risk to as low as is reasonably practicable.
12. If the residual risk is green, additional controls are not necessary.
13. If the residual risk is amber you can continue but you must identify and implement further controls to reduce the risk as low as reasonably practicable.
14. If the residual risk is red do not continue with the activity until additional controls have been implemented and the risk is reduced.
15. Control measures should follow the risk hierarchy, where appropriate as per the pyramid above.
16. The cost of implementing control measures can be taken into account but should be proportional to the risk i.e. a control to reduce low risk may not need to be carried out if the cost is high but a control to manage high risk means that even at high cost the control would be necessary.



International Travel Form

PGT Dissertation (*travelling to home country*)

THIS TWO PAGE INTERNATIONAL TRAVEL FORM (PGT Dissertation) must be submitted at least 10 working days **PRIOR** to travel, as proof of travel and risk approval. You will be required to consider the level of risk related to your home country, trip, dissertation and method of research. See Section 5 to complete the risk assessment details, if your trip is low risk you may refer to a GENERIC risk assessment, if there is a higher risk identified in any category you will be required to complete a SPECIFIC risk assessment. These can be found in the International Toolkit at the second link below.

Please visit Health, Safety and Risk Directorate site prior to travelling: [International Travel Toolkit \(sharepoint.com\)](https://soton.ac.uk/sharepoint.com/teams/HealthSafetyRisk/SitePages/Travel.aspx)
<https://soton.ac.uk/sharepoint.com/teams/HealthSafetyRisk/SitePages/Travel.aspx> *Travel Insurance (sharepoint.com)

Section 1. General details of trip *To be completed by the person travelling*

Faculty/School/Department:

NOTE: In an emergency the 24hr security central control room (CCR) should be contacted on +44 (0) 23 8059 3311

Single Traveller

Name of student travelling:

***Insurance:** The University's Travel Insurance Policy covers overnight stays and longer, Liability Insurance covers day trips – returning to UK same day (please ensure you understand the extent of cover for both). If uncertain, please email [INSURE](mailto:INSURE@uoi.soton.ac.uk)

Section 2. Outline Travel itinerary - MANDATORY FOR ALL TRIPS (provide details of travel including flight/train/coach/ferry and accommodation details, once your request to travel has been approved and your bookings are complete). Please add/amend the following in accordance with your travel arrangements/methods

Country (ies):

Cities/Areas/Regions:

Departure Date

Flight number

Return Date

Flight number

Accommodation (Please include type of - e.g. home address, hotel, lodgings, camping) (Air BnB and other unregulated accommodation are not approved by the University)

Section 3. Overseas Contact – required by the University – for the Faculty to contact you and your host

Most reliable contact details for you whilst travelling and/or working overseas

Name

Address

Telephone

E-mail

Host organisation/Company contact details/ In-country contacts (if more than one, please enter all)

Name

Address

Telephone

E-mail

Name

Address

Telephone

E-mail

Section 4. Information – for you whilst travelling (in case of incident or accident)	
Emergency numbers for Country(ies)/Destination(s) e.g. UK 999 USA 911 etc...	
Security emergency contact in the UK 24 hour University (Security)Central Control Room (CCR)	+44 (0) 23 8059 3311

Section 5 – Specify type of risk assessment
☐ Generic (low risk activity) – complete section 5A <i>(This is online, pre-populated, and for you to read, refer and adhere to, only)</i> ☐ Specific (higher risk activity) – complete section 5B

Section 5A. Generic Risk Assessment - approval of use, by supervisor and declaration (no need to submit)

DECLARATION: I can confirm this trip is adequately covered by the appropriate Generic Risk Assessment for International Travel.
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Section 5B. Specific Risk Assessment For specific activities/countries, risk ratings will vary, as will certain areas/regions, so please ensure you have thoroughly researched travel advice on the FCO website. Please enter Residual Risk Ratings below (the ratings AFTER controls measures) .
--

A. Country/Area	Low ☐	Medium ☐	High ☐
B. Emergency Preparedness	Low ☐	Medium ☐	High ☐
C. Travel/Transport	Low ☐	Medium ☐	High ☐
D. Accommodation <i>(You must only use regulated accommodation in order to comply with University policy – e.g. not Air BnB etc.)</i>	Low ☐	Medium ☐	High ☐
E. Activity(ies)	Low ☐	Medium ☐	High ☐
F. Wellbeing	Low ☐	Medium ☐	High ☐

RISK DECLARATION: I can confirm this trip requires a Specific Risk Assessment for International Travel.
--

I have completed a full risk assessment to accompany this form ☐
--

Section 6. Declaration

I confirm I have fully considered and completed this document and that adequate measures are in place to minimise risk to myself and others.
--

Student Name	Signature	Date
		Click here to enter a date.

Section 4. Supervisor Approval - PLEASE NOTE: you are approving ALL of the following

RISK ASSESSMENT - I have approved the use of a suitable and sufficient risk assessment (Generic)	GENERIC ☐
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RISK ASSESSMENT - I have approved or escalated a specific risk assessment for approval	SPECIFIC ☐ ESCALATED ☐
---	--

Name/Position	Signature	Date
		Click here to enter a date.

Section 5. Escalated Approval – VC's Office/Dean/Head of School or Directorate/Department:

I have approved the use of a suitable and sufficient specific risk assessment	(ESCALATED) SPECIFIC ☐
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Name/Position	Signature	Date
		Click here to enter a date.

Please retain this form in order to complete Post travel summary and Debrief meeting forms, if applicable.

Appendix 6. Lists of Databases

Updated January 2024

Databases: Academic Literature

More information and links to databases are available [on the library website](#).

Database	Access	Description
Business Source Premier	Online via Library website. Worldwide access with iSolutions login or VPN.	Business and related literature, including over 2000 full text journals.
Econlit	Online via Library website. Worldwide access with iSolutions login or VPN.	Worldwide economic literature including journal articles and working papers (NO FULL TEXT).
Emerald	Online via Library website. Worldwide access with iSolutions login or VPN.	Full text journal articles on management and economics.
JSTOR	Online via Library website. Worldwide access with iSolutions login or VPN.	Full text journal archive covering many subjects.
PsycARTICLES	Online via Library website. Worldwide access with iSolutions login or VPN.	Full text, peer-reviewed scholarly and scientific articles in psychology.
PsycINFO	Online via Library website. Worldwide access with iSolutions login or VPN.	Journal articles, book chapters, books, and dissertations, in all psychology and related disciplines (NO FULL TEXT).
Web of Science Core Collection	Online via Library website. Worldwide access with iSolutions login or VPN.	Peer reviewed journal articles and conference papers covering many subjects (NO FULL TEXT).

Databases: Financial Information and Statistical Data

More information and links to databases are available via: <https://library.soton.ac.uk/business/databases/companyinfo> (please check this website for updates)

Database	Access	Description	Notes
Bloomberg	For more details about Bloomberg, please see the FinLab https://sotonac.sharepoint.com/teams/finlab Bloomberg Resources can be accessed by clicking on this link here .	Bloomberg is a leading financial data provider.	
BoardEx	This data is automatically available to staff and research postgraduate students in the Southampton Business School. For more information, please see https://soton.boardex.com/Web/ and on the SharePoint link here .	It is a business relationship mapping and executive insight platform for private and public organizations. It provides up-to-date biographical information on board members, C-suite executives, senior leaders, and professional advisors, around the globe.	
British Standards Online	http://www.bsigroup.co.uk/ is a public website. Additionally, the University subscribes, and this provides access to their information, reports, and documentation	Since its foundation in 1901 as the Engineering Standards Committee, BSI Group has grown into a leading global independent business services organization providing standard-based solutions in more than 140 countries.	
CCH Online (formerly GAAP Extra)	Online via Library website. Username & password required	Information for accountants, tax practitioners and financial professionals, including accountancy and auditing standards.	See Library website for usernames and passwords.
CSMAR	The database can be accessed at https://global.csmar.com/ Please contact our engagement librarian for more up-to-date information regarding this database.	CSMAR, short for China Stock Market & Accounting Research Database, is a comprehensive research-oriented database focusing on China Finance and Economy.	
Data.gov.uk	Open access via http://data.gov.uk	The Government is releasing public data to help people understand how government works and how policies are made. Some of this data is already available, but data.gov.uk brings it together in one searchable website.	
Refinitiv: DataStream, Workspace	Financial and economic data for countries and companies worldwide can be accessed https://sotonac.sharepoint.com/teams/FinLab .	It provides access to detailed historical macroeconomic and financial data from both developed and emerging markets including equities, market indices, company accounts, macroeconomics, bonds, foreign exchange, interest rates, commodities, and derivatives.	
FAME	Online via Library website. You must log in with your SUSSED username and password both on campus and off campus. Worldwide access with iSolutions login or VPN.	FAME provides Detailed information about UK and Irish companies for the last 10 years, including publicly listed and private companies	Works best in Google Chrome or Firefox

FitchConnect	How to use FitchConnect, please see click on this link here . For access, please email libengs@soton.ac.uk	It provides detailed information, including financial statements, ratios, and credit ratings for over 30,000 banks worldwide. Data is available for the last 10 years. It also includes economic data and credit ratings for countries, and bonds and securities for banks. We do not have access to data for insurance companies	Works best in Google Chrome.
Hemscott Company Guru	Online via Library website. VPN required off campus.	Research into the companies, people and news that drive the UK stock market. Company fundamentals for 300,000 UK companies, including charts, ratios, news and director biographies. Updated daily.	
Gale Newspaper Database	Online via Library website. Worldwide access with iSolutions login or VPN.	Full text access from 1980s/90s to the Financial Times, Guardian, Independent, Independent on Sunday, Observer, and the Times.	
National Audit Office	Open access via http://www.nao.org.uk/publications.aspx	The National Audit Office (NAO) scrutinises public spending on behalf of Parliament. The audit of central government has two main aims. To hold government departments and bodies to account for the way they use public money, and to help public service managers improve performance and service delivery.	
Nexis UK	Online via Library website. Worldwide access with iSolutions login.	Company profiles, industry news and worldwide newspapers, including the Financial Times.	
OECD Institutional Investors Statistics	OECD Institutional Investors Statistics is freely available via Library website.	Annual and quarterly data at country level covering the level and structure of the financial assets of institutional investors (investment funds, insurance companies and pension funds) in the OECD countries, and the Russian Federation	
Passport	Online via Library website. Worldwide access with iSolutions login or VPN.	Global market research and company profiles. Statistics on industries, consumers and countries.	
ReportLinker	Online via Library website. Only free content is available.	Freely available market reports, official industry reports, company profiles and market statistics.	
SDC	Access this via WRDS. Then select Thomson/Refinitiv > SDC.	Historical datasets on M&A, M&A events, M&A advisors.	Our subscription does not provide access to SDC New Issues.
STATISTA	STATISTA can be access online via Library website. Worldwide access with iSolutions login or VPN. For more information, including access and tutorials, please refer to https://library.soton.ac.uk/Statista	This is an extensive statistics platform covering over 1.5 million data sets (and adding an additional 500 day) with revenue forecasts from 2015 to 2020 on over 400 industries. Data is collected from over 18,000 sources covering over 75,000 different topics.	

UK Data Service (UKDS)	http://ukdataservice.ac.uk/	UKDS holds a range of data sets, both qualitative and quantitative. International Macrodatabank disseminates and supports both aggregate and survey UK Data Service databanks.aspx international datasets for UK FE (UKDS) and HE.	
UK National Statistics	Open access via www.gov.uk	The Government Statistical Service (GSS) produces National Statistics and other official statistics, analysis, interpretation and provides statistical advice to improve understanding and help decision-making	
UN data	Open access via http://data.un.org/	Reports and data banks collected and published by various UN agencies.	
WRDS	This database is available from https://wrds-www.wharton.upenn.edu/ . Please contact our engagement librarian for more up-to-date information regarding this database.	It provides a range of financial data.	